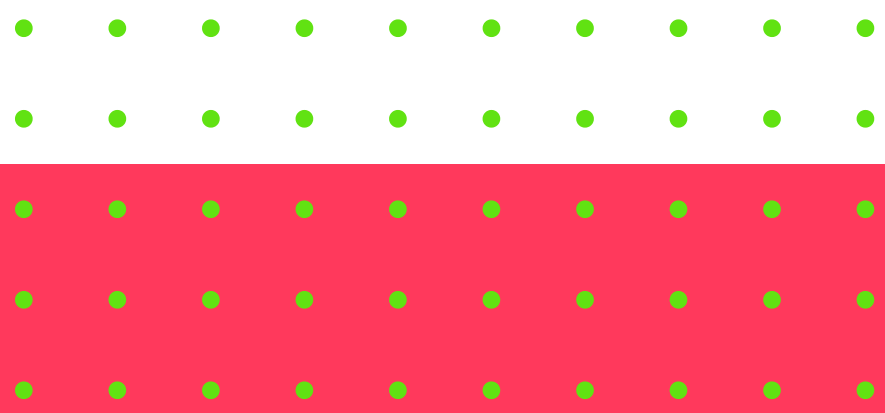




AIRBNB NOT JUST A BED AND BREAKFAST: A SAFE HAVEN FOR UKRAINIAN REFUGEES

Ashley Joyce



airbnb.org

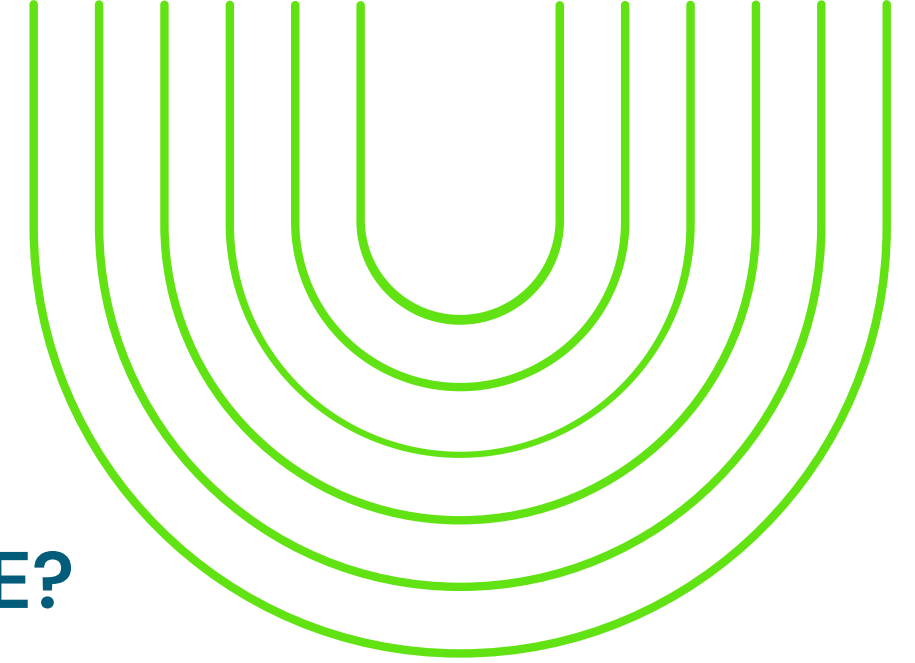
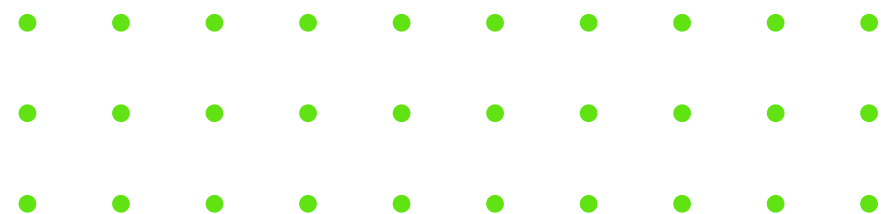
01. WHAT MOTIVATED AIRBNB TO HOST STAYS AS A HUMANITARIAN AID STRATEGY DURING THE WAR IN UKRAINE?

02. WHAT PLANNING AND COMMUNICATION EFFORTS ENABLED 100,000 REFUGEES TO RECEIVE TEMPORARY HOUSING?

03. WHAT PARTNERSHIPS AND MESSAGING FRAMES SUPPORTED THESE EFFORTS?

04. HOW DID AIRBNB'S STAKEHOLDERS REACT, AND WHAT BUSINESS IMPACT DID THE EFFORT HAVE?

**RESEARCH
QUESTIONS**





GLOBAL LEADER IN SHORT-TERM RENTALS,
OPERATING IN OVER 220 COUNTRIES & OVER
4 MILLION RENTALS LISTED





Belong Anywhere



Core Values



Champion the Mission

We're united in partnership with our community to create connection, which enables belonging.



Be a Host

We're caring, open, and encouraging to everyone we work with.



Embrace the Adventure

We're driven by open curiosity, hopeful resilience, and the belief that every person can grow.



Be a Cereal Entrepreneur

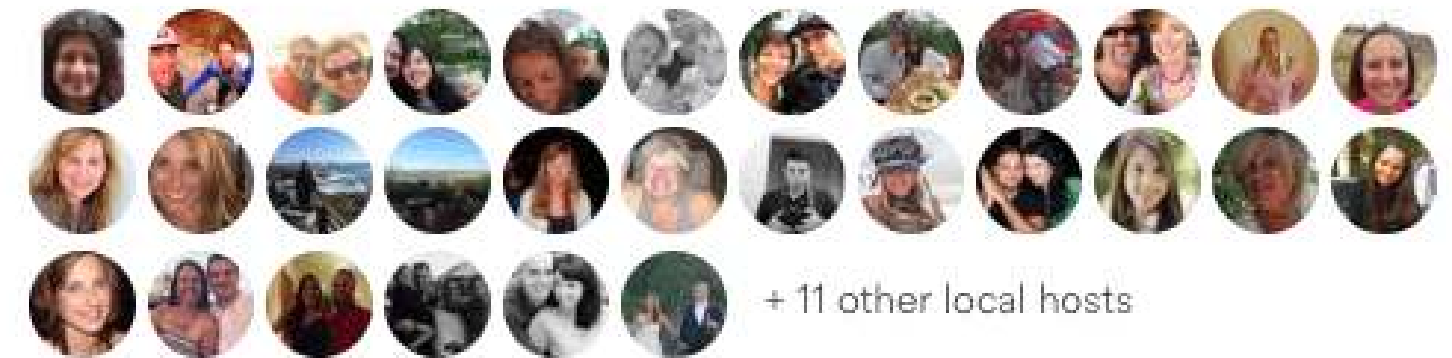
We're determined and creative in transforming our bold ambitions into reality.

HISTORY OF AIRBNB'S DISASTER RESPONSE PROGRAM

- history of crisis response began in 2012 during Hurricane Sandy when a New York host offered free housing to evacuees.
- Disaster Response Program, which facilitated housing for those displaced by crises.



Join the community of 41 hosts who have opened their homes to evacuees for free.



FORMATION OF AIRBNB.ORG

- in 2020, Airbnb.org was formalized as a nonprofit, dedicated to continuing these efforts independently of Airbnb's business operations.
- by the time of the Ukraine crisis in 2022, Airbnb.org had already housed over 20,000 Afghan refugees

airbnb.org



Introducing Airbnb.org



Subscribe

611



Share

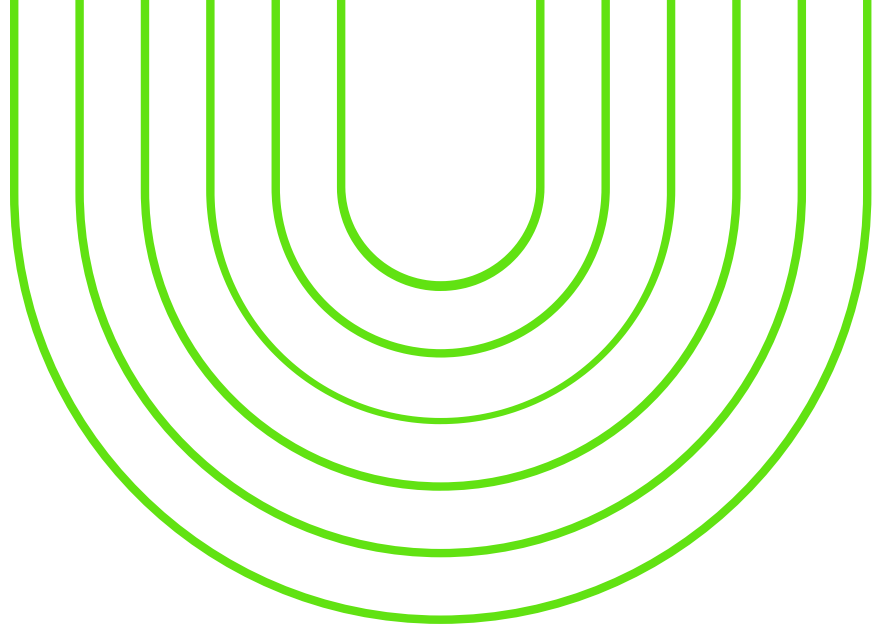


110,639 views Dec 7, 2020

A new nonprofit that opens homes in times of crisis. Airbnb.org is inspired by our host community, and we're proud to say it began eight years ago with the actions of a single host—Shell.

After Hurricane Sandy struck in 2012, Shell sprang into action, sharing her home with a family forced to evacuate theirs. Her generosity inspired thousands of other hosts to do the same, and since then, over 75,000 people in 104 countries have been housed during emergencies.





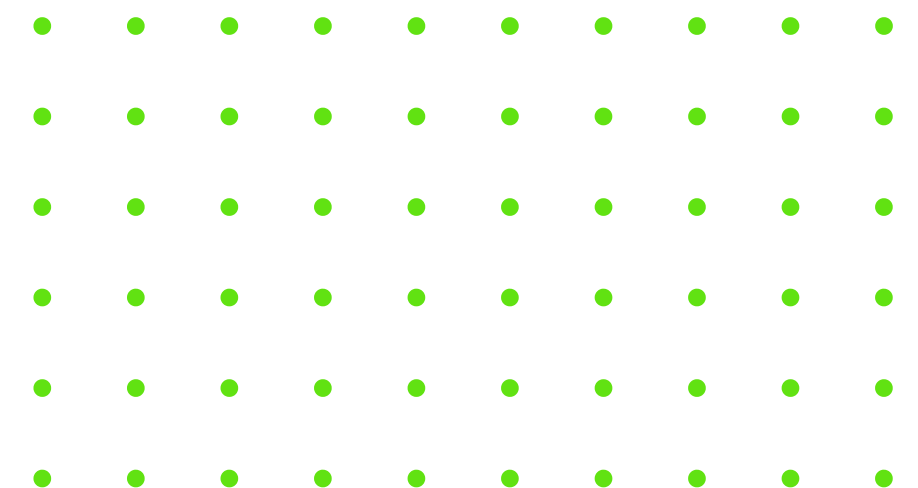
MISSIONS

Airbnb's mission is to create a world where anyone can feel at home and belong anywhere



airbnb.org

Our mission is to unlock the power of sharing space, resources, and support in times of need.





Those Affected

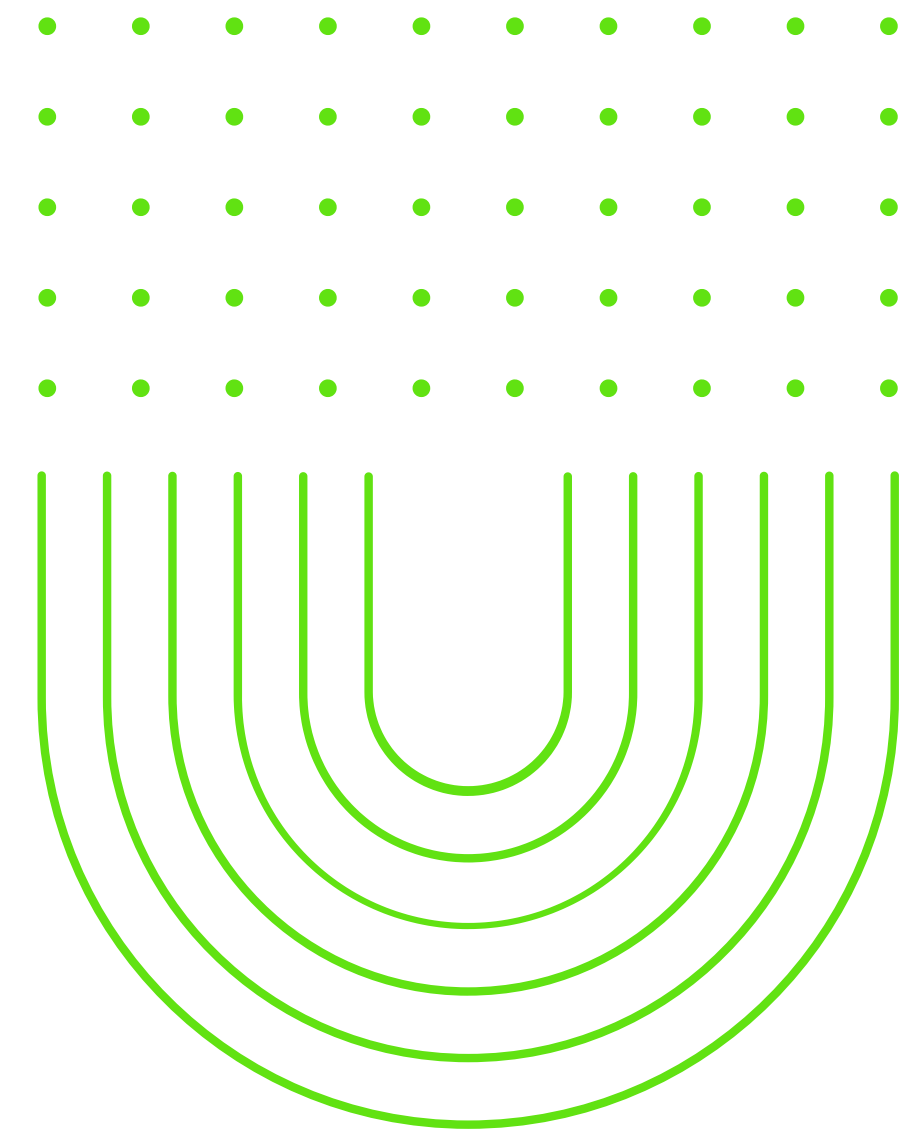
Russia's attack on Ukraine

- verified deaths of 10,582 civilians during the war (Statista).
- 43 million Ukrainians were forced to flee their country (Statista).



Public Opinion

- largely negative toward Russia, especially in Ukraine and Western countries.
- In the U.S., 69% view Russia unfavorably
- many believe the conflict should continue until Ukraine regains all its territory.



**RUSSIA
UKRAINE
WAR**

COMMUNICATION OPPORTUNITY

*Crisis communication & Corporate
Social Responsibility combined*

- Airbnb community + Leadership
- Hosts
- Local governments
- Donors (including celebrity donors)

PARTNERS



- HIAS
- Church World Service
- Canadian Ukrainian Immigrant Aid Society (CUIAS)
- Calgary Catholic Immigration Society
- GEM
- EURORDIS
- Community Sponsorship Hub

KEY PLAYERS



JOE GEBBIA

co-founder of Airbnb, and
the founder of Airbnb.org.

BRIAN CHESKY

co-founder of Airbnb, CEO
of Airbnb

Meet our board.

airbnb.org



Jennifer Bond

‘Airbnb has proven the power of connecting people and welcoming strangers. Airbnb.org aims to use that power to change lives and transform our world. It is a privilege to be a part of that journey.’



Jay Carney

‘Airbnb.org is a powerful example of how technology can be a force for good. I’m honored to be part of Airbnb.org’s efforts to support communities in times of crisis by providing people free, temporary housing as they rebuild their lives.’



Joe Gebbia

‘I’m inspired by what began with a message from a host, and became a movement of 100,000 people offering their homes to their community. In these times of crisis, this work is more important than ever.’



Sharyanne McSwain

‘Housing is one of the most basic human needs and through their program the Airbnb.org team provides housing during those moments of the greatest need.’

[More about Sharyanne](#)



Catherine Powell

‘Working closely with its partners and Hosts, Airbnb.org has seen its impact dramatically increase and has recently carried out some of its largest responses to date. I am honored to deepen my involvement with Airbnb.org as a Board Member.’

[More about Catherine](#)



Rich Serino

‘I have seen first hand the need for short-term housing after a disaster or crisis, and Airbnb.org has and will continue to save and change lives by assisting with short-term housing.’

[More about Rich](#)



Jocelyn Wyatt

‘I was excited to join the Board of Airbnb.org because of the significant impact I believe we can have by providing housing and resources to those in need.’

airbnb.org

AIRBNB.ORG UKRAINE CAMPAIGN TIMELINE

- Airbnb.org partnering with NGOs in neighboring countries
- Hosts and donors contribute
- Grassroots actions from the Airbnb community to provide direct financial support to Ukrainian hosts

- Airbnb.org expands its partnerships to include more humanitarian organizations to streamline housing placements and extend support to refugees relocated further into Western Europe and North America.

- Airbnb.org's first impact report offers an overview of the organization's work over the past three years.
- Airbnb.org continues to support displaced Ukrainians, collaborating with new and existing partners, including long-term stays.
- Airbnb.org intends to continue providing housing and resources for displaced Ukrainians and leverage its platform to address other humanitarian crises worldwide.

February 2022

March 2022

April 2022

May 2022

June-December 2022

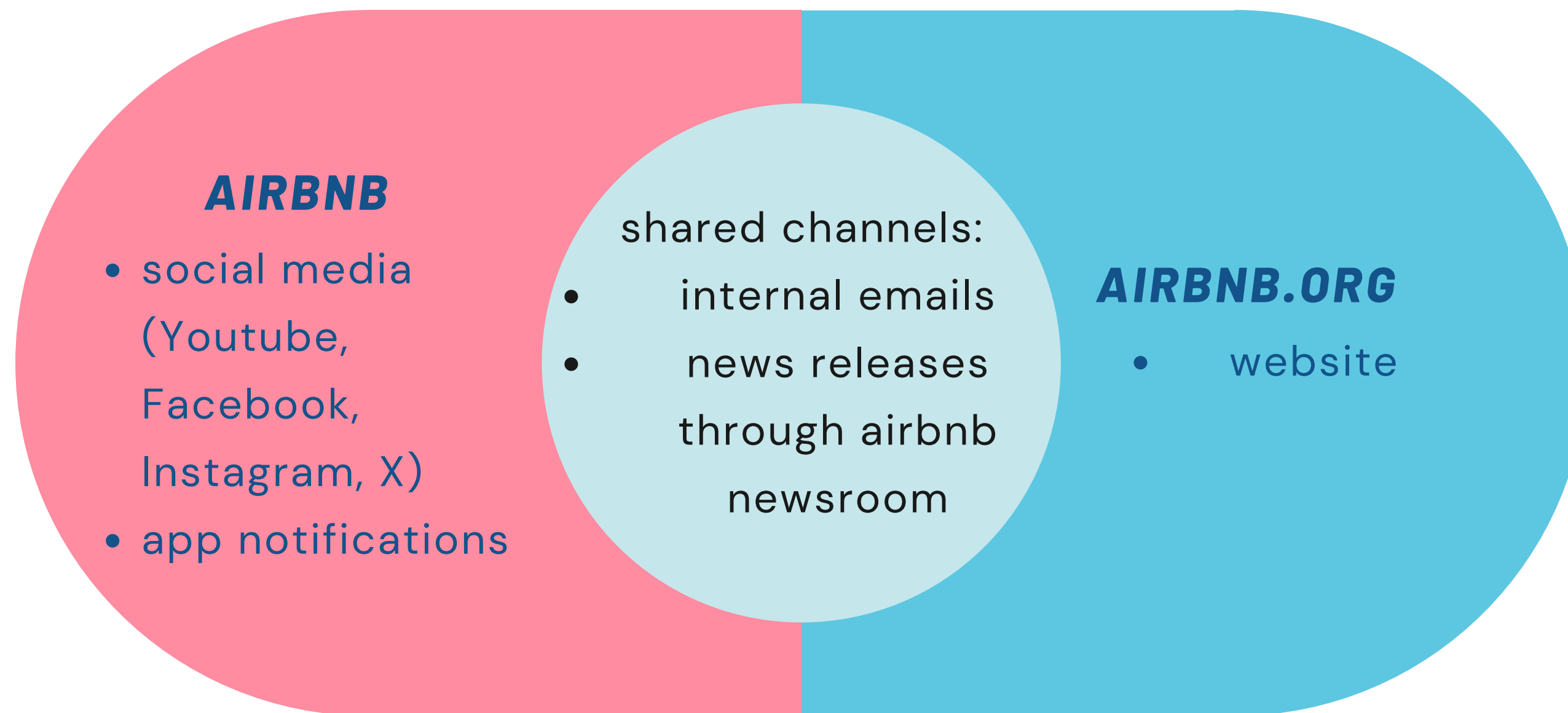
PRESENT

- Russia invaded Ukraine on February 24, 2024
- February 28, Airbnb.org pledges to offer free, short-term housing to up to 100,000 refugees.

- Airbnb.org announces it has provided housing to tens of thousands of Ukrainian refugees.

- Airbnb.org reports milestones in assisting Ukrainian refugees, surpassing 137,700 refugees housed by the end of the year

COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

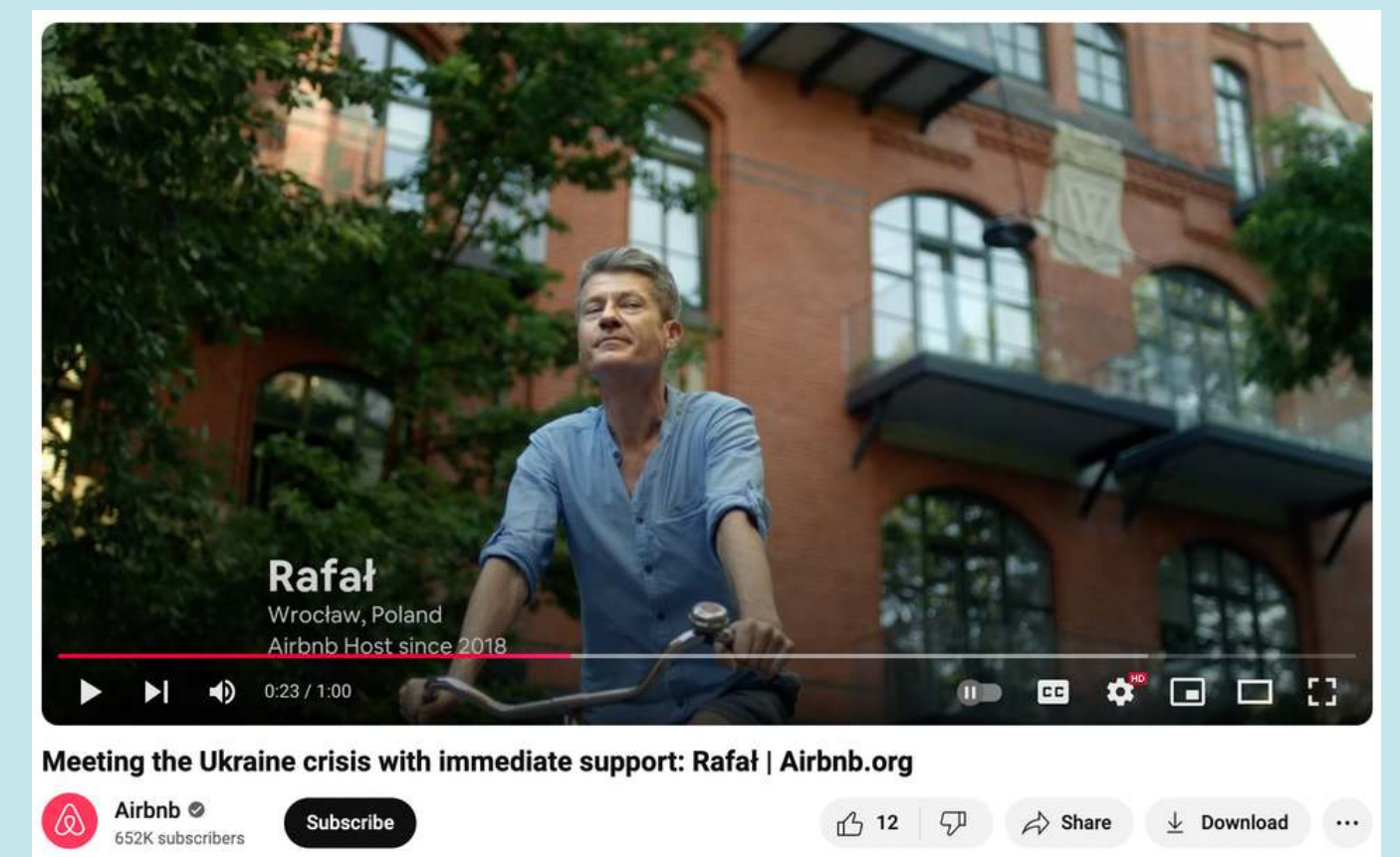
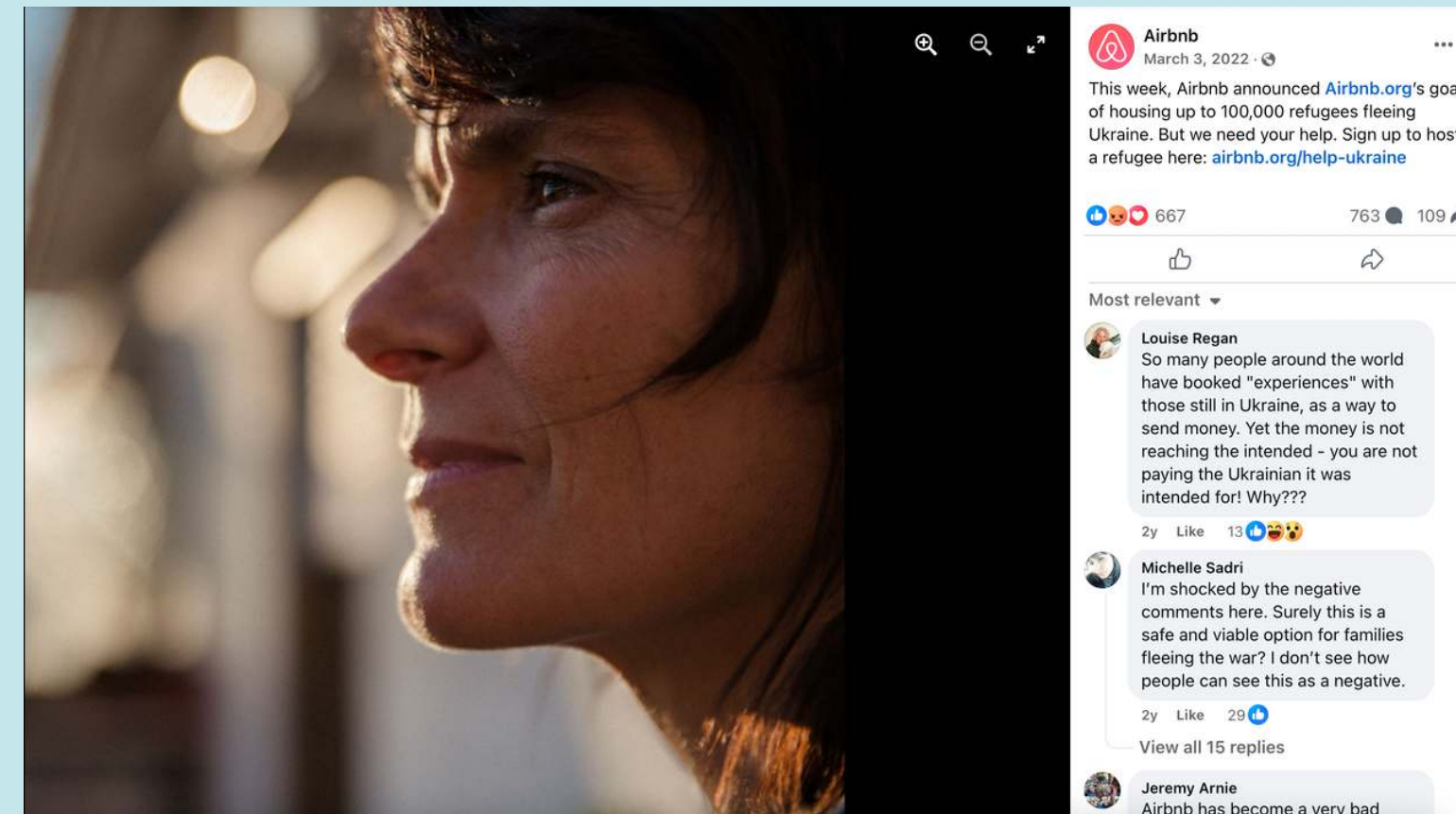
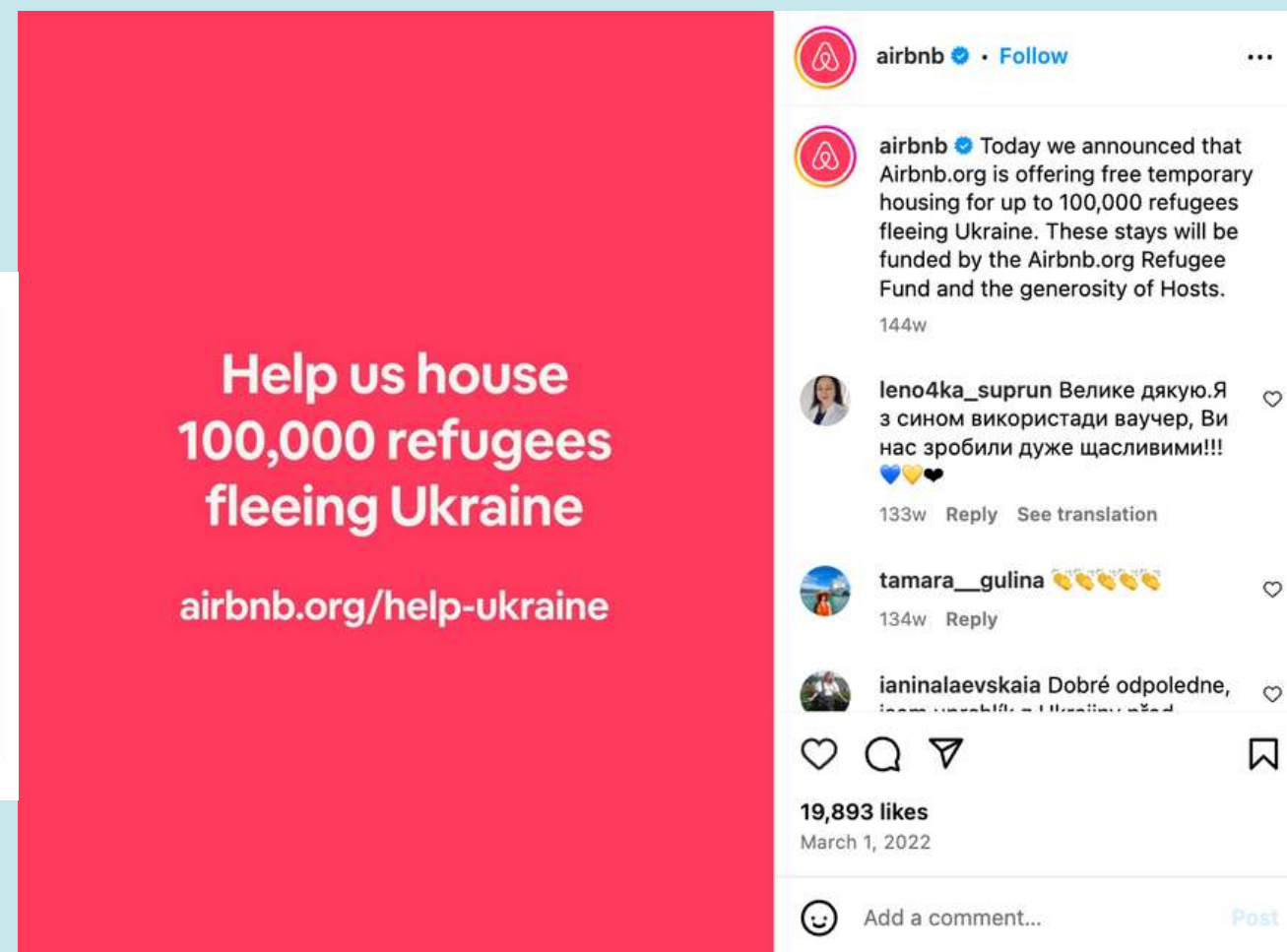


outside:

- media and news coverage
- advocacy through hosts, celebrity influencers (ex: gofundme and social posts)
- partner organizations

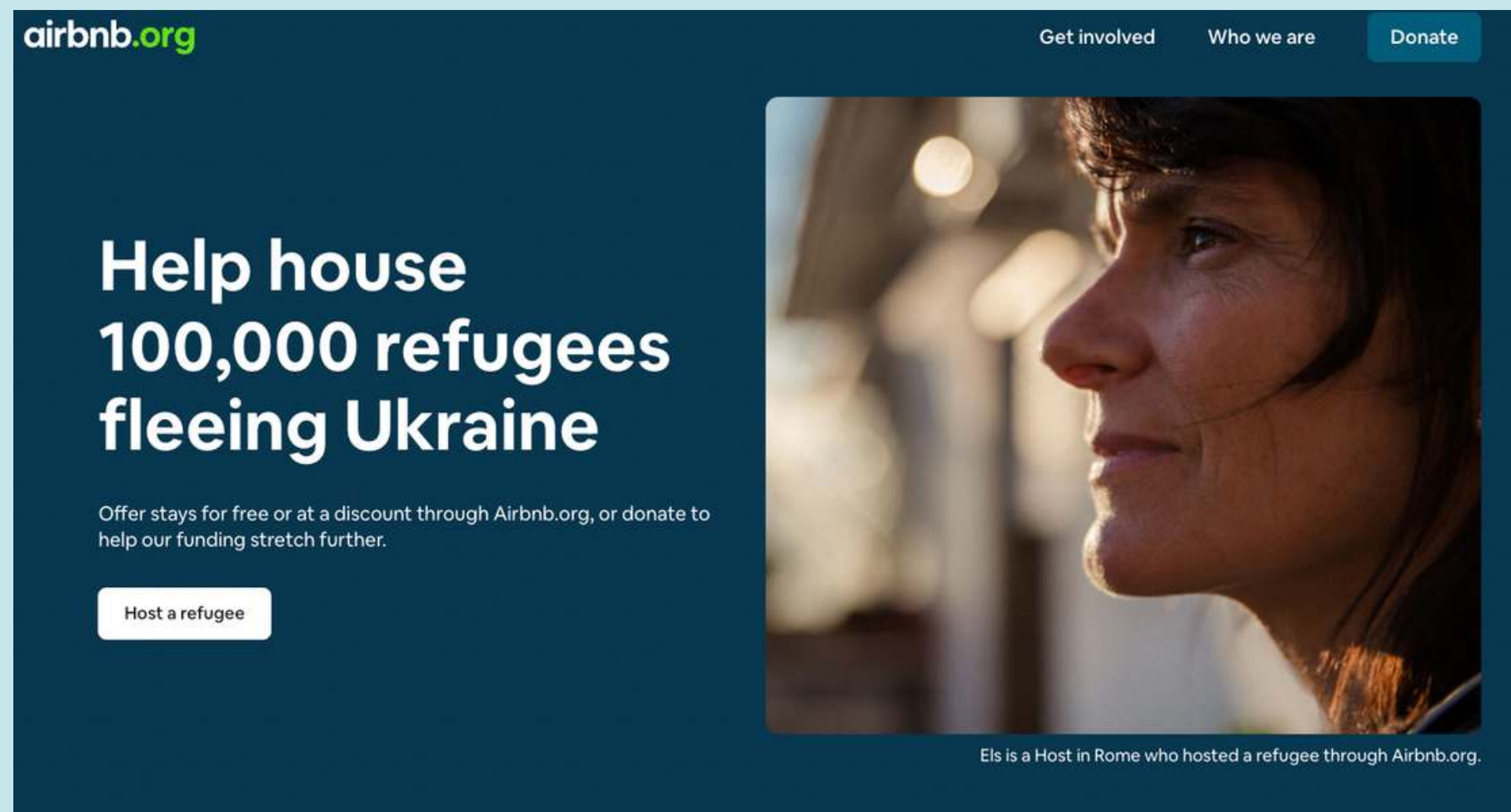
DIGITAL & SOCIAL MEDIA

- Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn, and YouTube
- shared impactful stories, videos, and graphics about refugees and their hosts
- including paid social ads



AIRBNB'S OWNED MEDIA

- app notifications, emails
- airbnb.org website resources
- Airbnb Newsroom



The screenshot shows the airbnb.org website with a dark blue header containing the logo and navigation links: "Get involved", "Who we are", and "Donate". The main content area features a large, close-up profile photo of a woman. To the left of the photo, the text reads: "Help house 100,000 refugees fleeing Ukraine". Below this, a smaller line of text says: "Offer stays for free or at a discount through Airbnb.org, or donate to help our funding stretch further." At the bottom left, there is a white button that says "Host a refugee". At the bottom right, below the photo, it says: "Els is a Host in Rome who hosted a refugee through Airbnb.org."

Ukraine



100,000 people fleeing Ukraine have found stays through Airbnb.org

August 31, 2022



More than 25,000 refugees fleeing Ukraine have found temporary housing via Airbnb.org

May 23, 2022



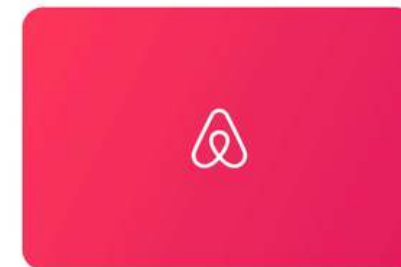
Offering housing to refugees fleeing Ukraine, from all communities

April 20, 2022



Update on Airbnb.org's work to support refugees fleeing Ukraine

March 29, 2022



Working with nonprofits and others to support refugees fleeing Ukraine

March 24, 2022

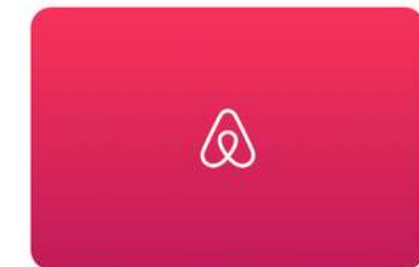


Save the Children Sweden partners with Airbnb.org to provide free housing to refugees fleeing Ukraine



Outreach to governments in Europe to support refugees fleeing Ukraine

March 16, 2022



A \$10 million matching donation to support refugees fleeing Ukraine

March 15, 2022

PARTNERSHIPS



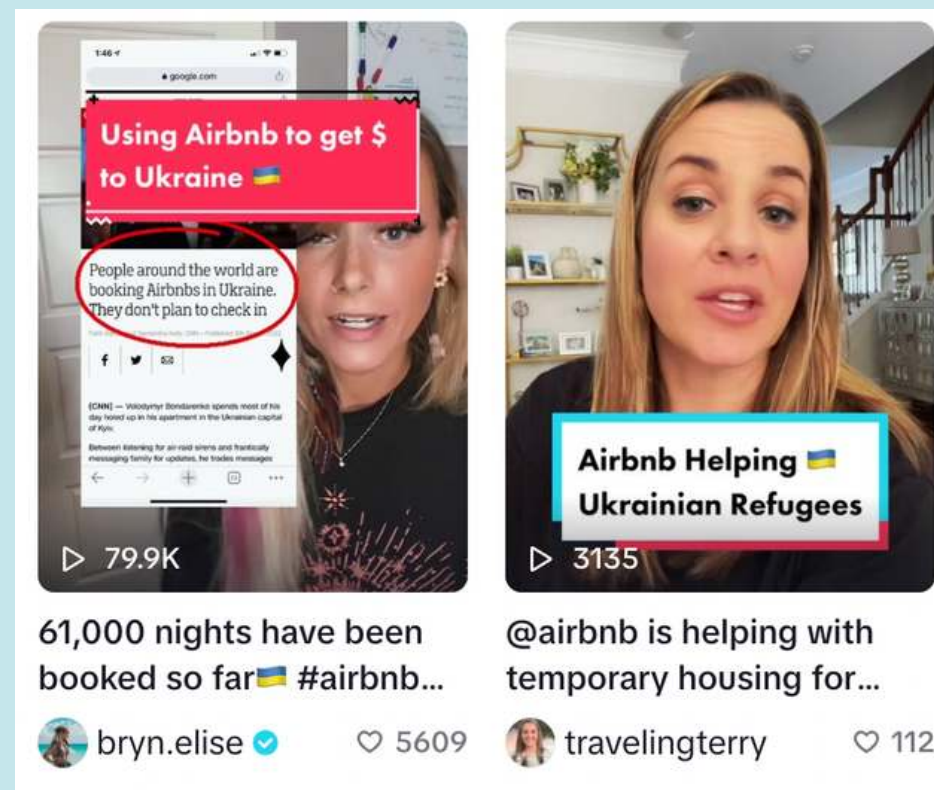
International Rescue Committee (IRC) and UNHCR to help disseminate information through their communication networks. Local advocacy groups and refugee support organizations facilitated direct connections with affected communities



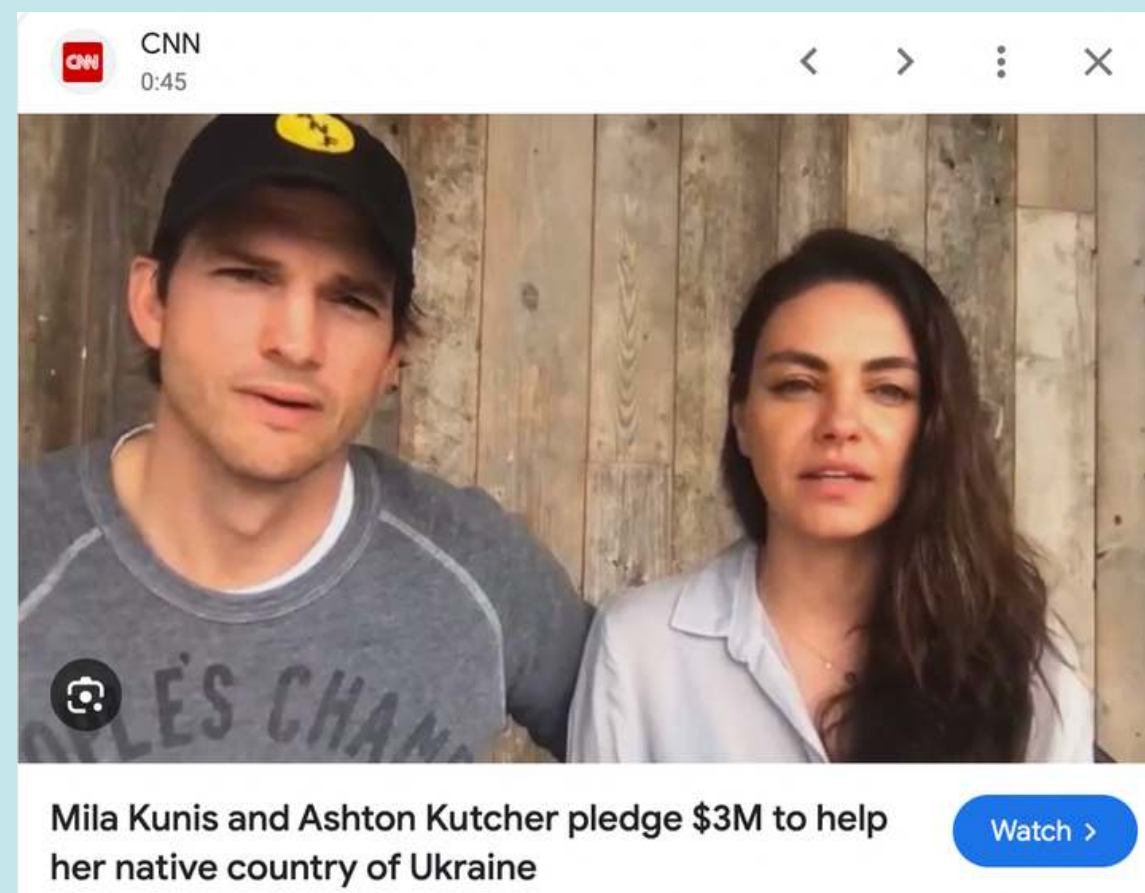
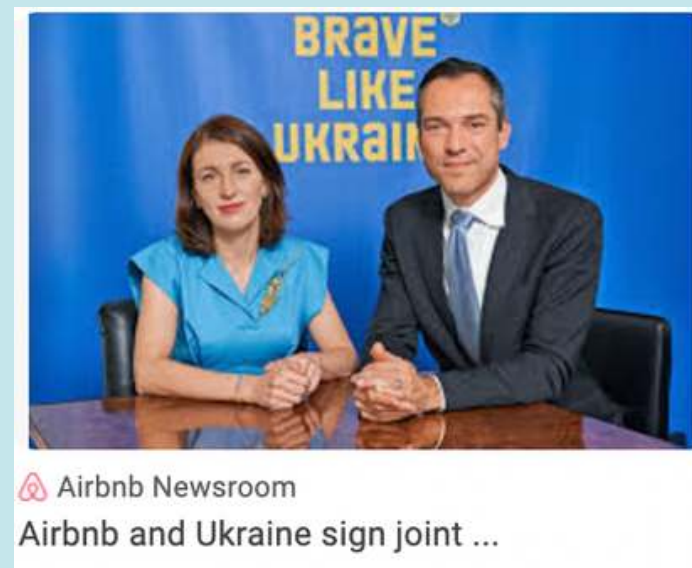
“The community mobilizing team at CORE, we’re all coming together because of our incredible stories and how passionate we are to save our community.”

Crista, Airbnb.org partner from nonprofit CORE

EARNED & MEDIA COVERAGE



coverage in major publications such as CNN, The Guardian, and Forbes, helping to spread awareness



Fox Business
Airbnb raises nearly \$37M for ...



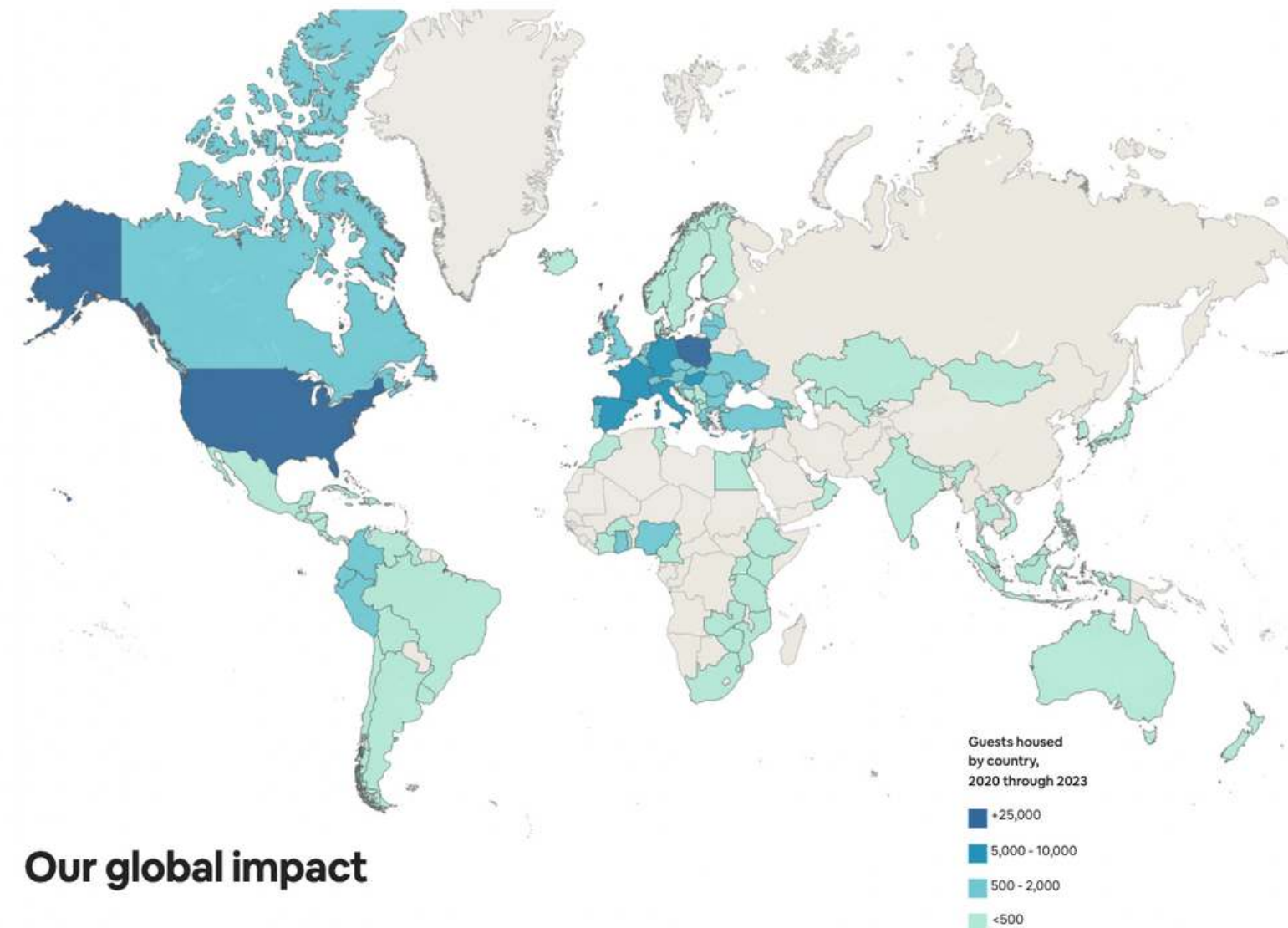
KEY IMPACTS

137,700

Guests housed

1M+

Nights housed
through Airbnb.org



airbnb.org

2020-2023 by the numbers

Data: December 2020 to September 2023

225,900 Guests housed

75,000

Free, temporary stays provided to guests

15

Average number of nights of an Airbnb.org stay

187

Countries and regions where Hosts have signed up with Airbnb.org

76,800

Hosts who have opted in to provide free or discount Airbnb.org stays

Some of our responses, 2020-2023

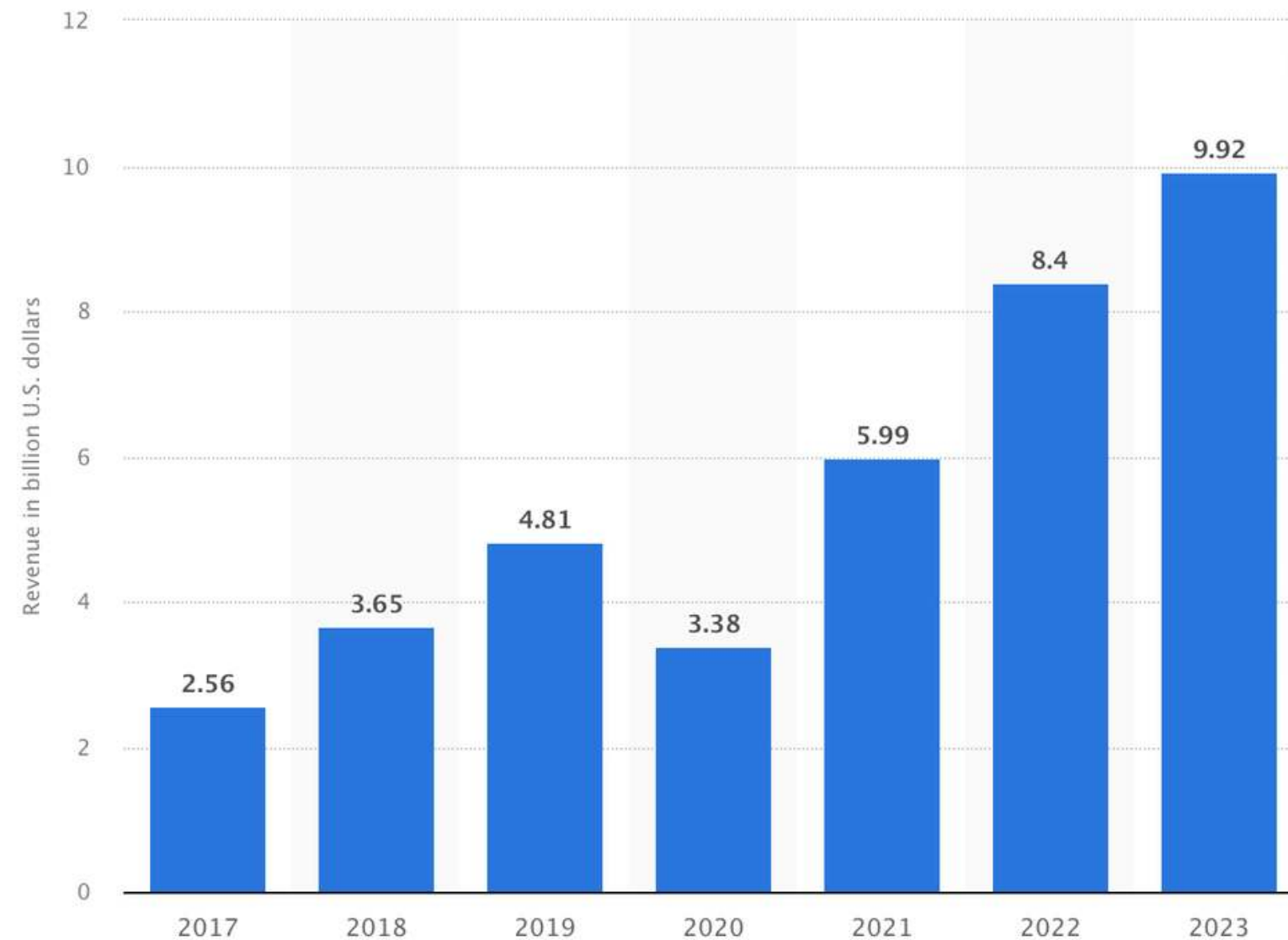
- | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Ukraine war | Hurricane Idalia (U.S.) |
| Afghan refugee crisis | Mississippi tornadoes (U.S.) |
| Venezuelan refugee crisis | Morocco earthquake |
| Hurricane Ian (U.S.) | Hurricane Fiona (U.S., P.R.) |
| Maui fires (U.S.) | Western Europe floods |
| Türkiye-Syria earthquakes | New South Wales floods (Aus.) |

Map credit: Mapbox OpenStreetMap

BUSINESS IMPACTS

Revenue of Airbnb worldwide from 2017 to 2023

(in billion U.S. dollars)



HUMAN IMPACTS



SITUATIONAL THEORY OF PUBLICS

**PROBLEM
RECOGNITION**

**CONSTRAINT
RECOGNITION**

**LEVEL OF
INVOLVEMENT**

FUTURE ACTIONS



Linda, a Host in Dallas, has welcomed refugees through Airbnb.org.

Offer a place to stay

Start hosting guests for free or at a discount.

How hosting works

- ✓ You'll provide a comfortable bed and basic amenities for anywhere from a few days to a few weeks. [Learn more about hosting refugee guests](#)
- ✓ Airbnb.org partners with nonprofits that check refugee guests for eligibility and assist them before, during, and after their stays.
- ✓ Airbnb provides Hosts with **AirCover**: \$1 million USD in liability insurance, \$3 million USD in damage protection, and more—at no cost to Hosts. Certain limitations and exclusions apply.

Host a refugee

Make a donation

Every donation helps fill a critical need for emergency stays for those fleeing Ukraine and others in crisis.

How donating works

- ✓ 100% of your donation will go toward connecting people with short term housing.
- ✓ Stays are completely free for guests of our program.
- ✓ Donations are tax deductible to the extent allowed under your local tax laws.

[Learn more about how donations work](#)

Donate now



Fode is a refugee guest who stayed with a Host in Italy through Airbnb.org.

How can you help?

I can donate

In times of crisis, your donation helps people find a place to call home.

Donate now

I can host

Join over 100,000 hosts and give people a free place to stay when they need it most.

Offer your space

RECCOMENDATIONS



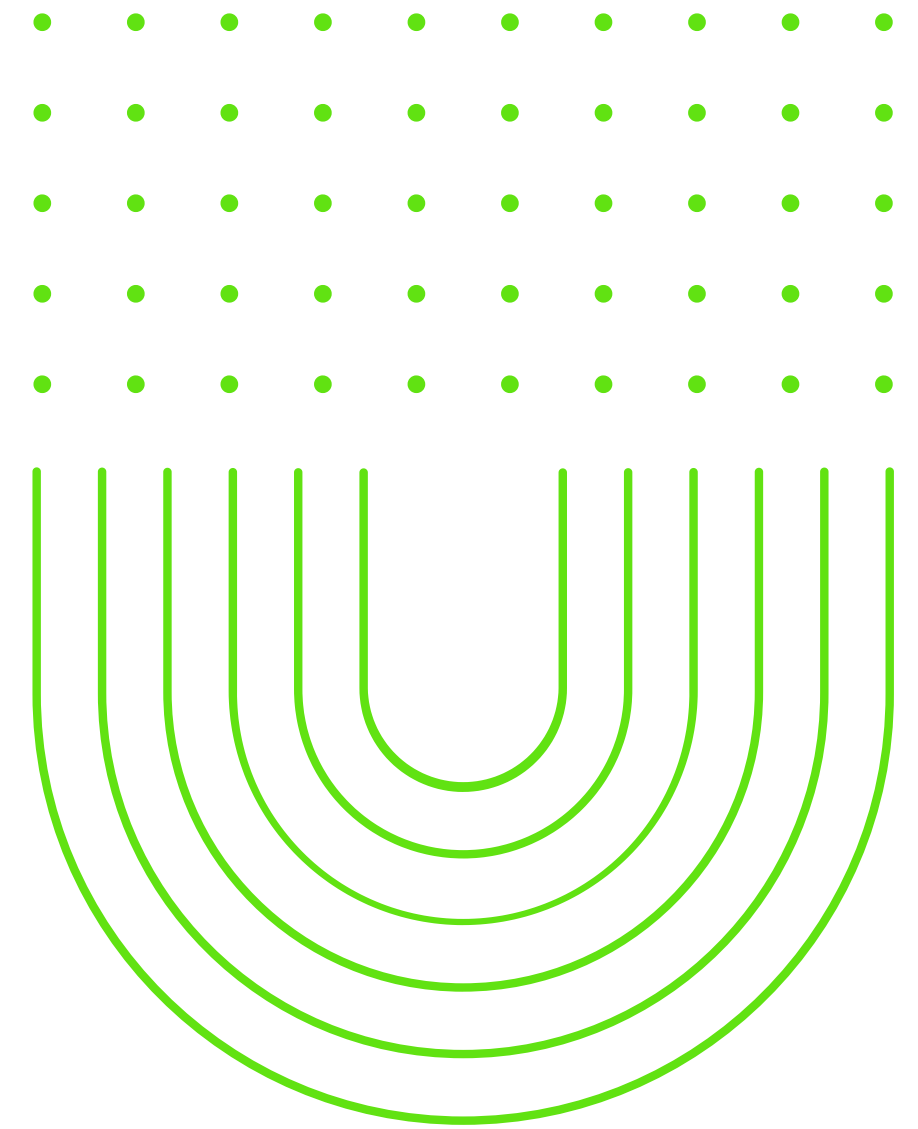
Clear up contorversies

- financial transparency for donations (especially for grassroots donations)
 - ensure aid reaches vulnerable populations
- government partnerships/communication – follow all laws
- create a statement about these issues



Separate Airbnb.org channels for Airbnb

- it's own Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, and X account – not Brian needs their own spokesperson
- separate messaging to community through a different app



RECCOMENDATIONS



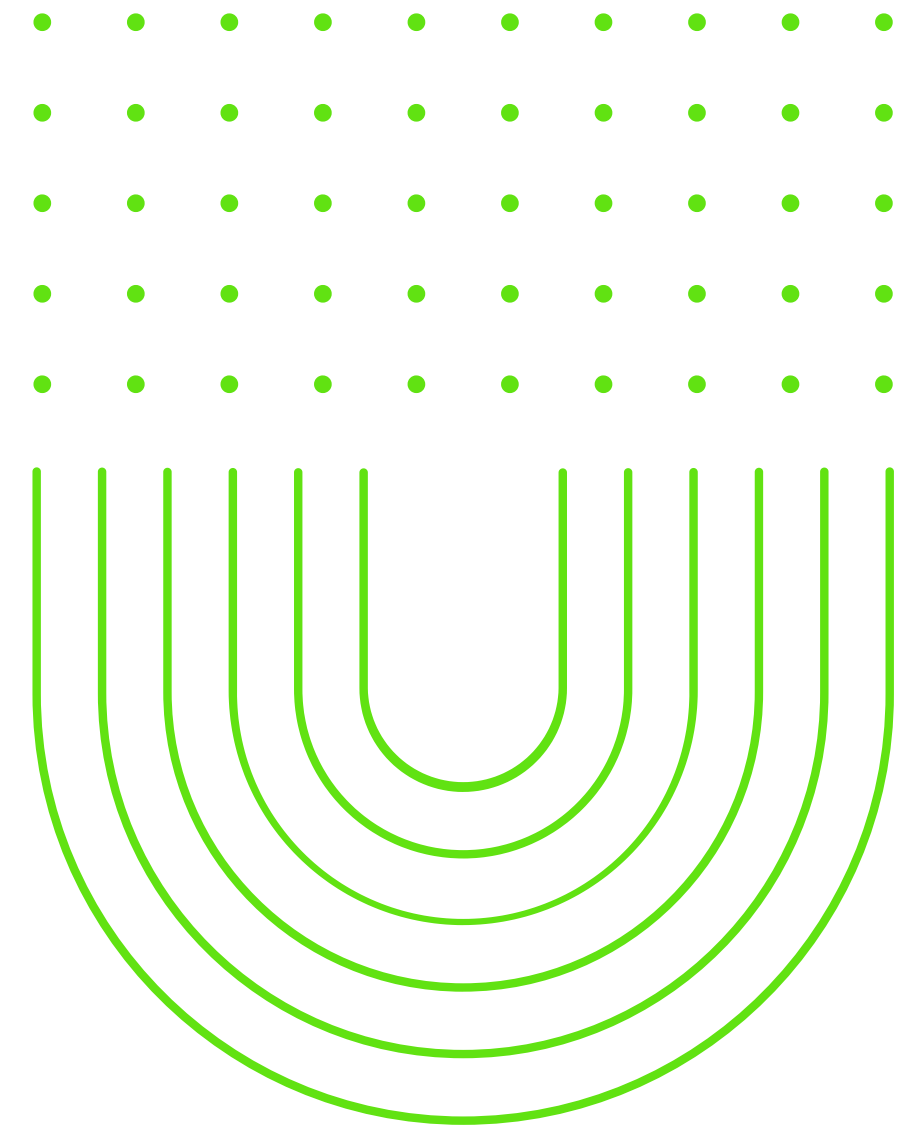
Pre Established Host Network

- more in depth vetting process
- create a separate community who are ready and reliable
- (through it's own platforms)



Long term wholistic approach

- messaging about how they are supporting people beyond donations and short term stays
- more partnerships with non profits providing food, employment, security, mental health needs, etc.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

activist mobilization

By converting public awareness into collective action, Airbnb.org presents a compelling case for support. Additionally, the organization encourages collaboration with activists to facilitate humanitarian efforts.

values and action alignment

This alignment of humanitarian aid with corporate values has positioned Airbnb as a leader in crisis response, setting a benchmark for socially responsible business practices.

nonprofit > CSR

The close connection between the two organizations, especially with Airbnb's name included in the nonprofit, allows the for-profit company to benefit from the positive reputation and brand image that the nonprofit provides.